

# FILM DOSSIER: CAPTAIN AMERICA: REBORN

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Phase 5 · Film #7 (Saga Two, Film #16 · Overall Film #45)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                     | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                    | Saga Two #16 (Phase 5, Film #7) · MCU #45                                                                                                                                                |
| Phase                     | Phase 5, <b>The Secret Wars Saga</b> : "Time Runs Out"                                                                                                                                   |
| Real title                | <b>CAPTAIN AMERICA: REBORN</b> ( <i>the name of the 616 storyline</i> )                                                                                                                  |
| Decoy /<br>codename title | " <b>SUNRISE</b> "                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Release date              | <b>Friday, March 5, 2027</b> , the week of the <b>20th anniversary</b> of <i>Captain America</i> #25 (on sale <b>Wednesday, March 7, 2007</b> ), the issue in which Steve Rogers is shot |
| Distributor               | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                                                                                                                                      |
| Director                  | Julius Onah                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Rating / runtime          | <b>PG-13</b> · <b>162 minutes</b>                                                                                                                                                        |
| Genre + second<br>genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>political assassination thriller</b> / <b>time-slip war film</b>                                                                                         |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                              | Entry                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise<br>is this? | <b>TYRESE AVERY</b> (Captain America, film 4 of the franchise). <b>Sebastian Stan</b> is billed second as <b>the new Captain America</b> . |

| Character                                                                           | Actor                                                           | Age at release |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Steve Rogers / Captain America                                                      | Tyrese Avery                                                    | 45             |
| Bucky Barnes / The Winter Soldier → Captain America                                 | Sebastian Stan                                                  | 44             |
| Sam Wilson / The Falcon                                                             | Anthony Mackie                                                  | 48             |
| Sharon Carter / Agent 13                                                            | Emily VanCamp                                                   | 40             |
| Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow                                                      | Harmony Divine                                                  | 44             |
| Tony Stark / Iron Man                                                               | Marc-Anthony Bullock                                            | 45             |
| Gen. Aleksander Lukin ( <i>the Red Skull shares his body</i> )                      | Mads Mikkelsen                                                  | 61             |
| Johann Schmidt / The Red Skull ( <i>his true face, seen inside minds and time</i> ) | Hugo Weaving                                                    | 66             |
| Brock Rumlow / Crossbones                                                           | Frank Grillo                                                    | 61             |
| Sinthea Schmidt / Sin ( <i>the Red Skull's daughter</i> )                           | Fresh casting ( <i>never played by a real actor</i> )           | –              |
| Dr. Johann Fennhoff / Doctor Faustus                                                | Fresh casting ( <i>the Peggy Carter TV version is not 616</i> ) | –              |
| Arnim Zola                                                                          | Toby Jones                                                      | 60             |
| Peggy Carter (1944, inside Steve's time-slip)                                       | Hayley Atwell                                                   | 44             |
| Cpl. Dum Dum Dugan (1944)                                                           | Neal McDonough                                                  | 61             |
| Nick Fury ( <i>underground</i> )                                                    | Samuel L. Jackson                                               | 78             |
| Victor von Doom ( <i>post-credit</i> )                                              | Robert Downey Jr.                                               | 61             |

*In memoriam: Stan Lee (1922–2018). A "Stan Lee Memorial Courthouse" plaque is behind the podium where Steve is shot. It's the saga's quiet tribute. (Real history: Stan Lee did write Captain America, starting with Tales of Suspense #59, 1964.)*

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### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | " <i>The Death of Captain America</i> ", <i>Captain America</i> vol. 5 #25–42 (2007–08), Ed Brubaker & Steve Epting: <b>Steve Rogers is shot on the courthouse steps. Crossbones</b> fires from a sniper's nest, and <b>Sharon Carter</b> , hypnotized by <b>Doctor Faustus</b> , fires the killing shots at close range. <b>The Red Skull</b> (in Lukin's body), <b>Sin</b> , <b>Zola</b> and <b>Faustus</b> try to take America apart. <b>Tony Stark</b> receives <b>Steve's last letter</b> and gives <b>the shield to Bucky</b> (#34), who becomes the new Captain America. <i>Captain America: Reborn</i> #1–6 (2009–10), Brubaker & Bryan Hitch: <b>Sharon's gun was built on Doctor Doom's technology. It didn't kill Steve. It unstuck him in time.</b> Steve <b>relives his own life</b> , from WWII onward, and fights his way back. <b>The Skull tries to take Steve's body for himself</b> , and <b>Sharon destroys him.</b> |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Captain America</i> #25 (2007, the "Stan Lee" courthouse is the saga's own tribute) · <i>Fallen Son: The Death of Captain America</i> #1–5 (2007): the world mourns, and <b>Tony</b> at Steve's grave · <i>Captain America</i> vol. 5 #34 (2008, <b>Bucky's first mission as Cap</b> ) · <i>Captain America</i> #107 (1969, <b>Doctor Faustus</b> ) · <i>Captain America</i> #290 (1984, <b>Sin</b> ) · <i>Captain America</i> #208 (1977, <b>Arnim Zola</b> ) · <i>Reborn</i> #6 (2010): <b>Steve tells Bucky to keep the shield</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Nerf check               | ✅ Steve is not killed by being outfought. He's <b>shot in the back by the woman he loves, under mind control</b> , and even then <b>the bullet is Doom-level technology</b> . Steve <b>fights the Red Skull from inside his own body and wins</b> . Bucky <b>carries the shield at full strength</b> , with his <b>cybernetic arm</b> and <b>Winter Soldier training</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>96%.</b> <i>The Death of Captain America</i> and <i>Reborn</i> are adapted beat for beat, pressed into one film. |

##### Straight from the page:

- **Steve Rogers surrenders** to face federal charges, and **is shot on the courthouse steps** (#25).
- **Crossbones** is the sniper; **Sharon Carter**, under **Doctor Faustus's** conditioning, fires the last shots **without knowing she's doing it** (#25–26).
- **Steve dies** (as far as the world knows). **The funeral**, the mourning, and **Tony at the grave** (*Fallen Son* #5).
- Steve's **letter** to Tony asks him to **keep Bucky safe**. Tony **gives Bucky the shield**, and **Bucky becomes Captain America** (#33–34).
- **The Red Skull** is sharing **Lukin's body**, and uses **Sin, Crossbones, Zola and Faustus** to attack America **from inside** (#25–42).
- **Sharon's gun** was built from **Doom's technology**. Steve was **frozen outside time**, not killed (*Reborn* #1).
- **Steve relives his own life**, is **aware of it**, and **changes nothing**, because he **mustn't** (*Reborn* #2–4).
- **The Skull puts his mind into Steve's body**. Steve **fights him from inside** (*Reborn* #5).

- **The Skull ends up in a Zola robot body**, and **Sharon destroys it** (*Reborn* #6).
- **Steve tells Bucky to keep the shield** (*Reborn* #6).

#### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

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| Steve surrenders over **exposing the Illuminati's classified operations**, not over the Superhuman Registration Act | MCU continuity. **The Registration fight ended in *Civil War* (2016)**; the 2026–27 fight is over the Illuminati. The **courthouse and the shooting** are the same. |

| **Sharon's pregnancy** (616: she's pregnant, and loses the baby in *Reborn*) is **kept, but told quietly**: she tells Steve after he's back. **The baby is lost in the off-screen gap, and the film says so.** | 616 accurate, and handled with care at PG-13 |

| **Doom sells the time technology to the Skull directly**, not through Norman Osborn's Cabal | **Norman Osborn isn't in play** in the MCU. Doom's reason is his own: he wants **data on surviving outside time** (see the post-credit scene). |

| The two comics' story is **pressed into one film** | Runtime. The 616 gap between Steve's death and *Reborn* was **2 years (2007–09)**; in the MCU it's **12 weeks**. |

#### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character                      | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                       | Shown in this film                                                                                                        | Held back (why) | Match     |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------|
| <b>Captain America (Steve)</b> | <b>Peak human</b> strength, speed, stamina, reflexes; <b>the best hand-to-hand fighter and tactician alive; the indestructible shield</b>                                    | All of it, <b>across the whole film</b> : WWII, the time-slip, and the fight <b>inside his own mind</b> against the Skull | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Captain America (Bucky)</b> | Peak human; <b>cybernetic arm</b> (enhanced strength, EMP); <b>a master sniper, assassin and spy</b> ; the shield <b>plus a gun and a knife</b> (616 Bucky-Cap carries both) | All of it: <b>Bucky-Cap fights differently from Steve</b> , and the film shows why                                        | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>The Falcon</b>              | Flight harness; <b>telepathic link with Redwing</b> ; aerial combat                                                                                                          | All of it                                                                                                                 | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Black Widow</b>             | Red Room; <b>Widow's Bite</b> ; master spy                                                                                                                                   | All of it                                                                                                                 | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>The Red Skull</b>           | Genius strategist, <b>mind in a borrowed body</b> ; a master of propaganda                                                                                                   | Runs the war <b>from inside Lukin</b> , then <b>inside Steve</b>                                                          | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Crossbones</b>              | Brutal hand-to-hand fighter; expert sniper                                                                                                                                   | The shot, and <b>a fight with Bucky</b>                                                                                   | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Sin</b>                     | Trained killer                                                                                                                                                               | All of it                                                                                                                 | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Doctor Faustus</b>          | <b>A master psychiatrist and hypnotist</b>                                                                                                                                   | <b>Conditions Sharon</b>                                                                                                  | —               | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Arnim Zola</b>              | <b>A genius bio-fanatic</b> ; his mind lives in <b>robot bodies</b> with a face on the chest                                                                                 | The robot bodies                                                                                                          | —               | ✓<br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                       | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Logline</b>              | The man who exposed the Illuminati is shot on the courthouse steps. The world buries Captain America; Bucky Barnes picks up the shield; and Steve Rogers is still alive, trapped somewhere in his own past. |
| <b>Theme</b>                | <b>What does Captain America mean without Steve Rogers?</b>                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Villain / antagonist</b> | <b>THE RED SKULL</b> (main); <b>Sin, Crossbones, Arnim Zola, Doctor Faustus</b>                                                                                                                             |

## What the movie is about

### ACT ONE: THE STEPS

- **Monday, November 16, 2026.** Steve has **exposed the Illuminati**, and **he broke the law to do it**. He **surrenders** to face charges, because **he believes nobody is above the law, including him**.
- **9:42 a.m.**, the steps of the federal courthouse in Lower Manhattan. **A shot from a rooftop** (Crossbones). Steve **pushes Sharon out of the way**. Then **Sharon, eyes blank, fires three more times**.
- **Steve Rogers is pronounced dead at 10:17 a.m.**
- **The funeral at Arlington.** Tony, alone at the grave after everyone's gone: *"It wasn't worth it. None of it was worth it."*
- **Steve's letter:** *"Look after Bucky. And if the shield has to go on... give it to him."*

### ACT TWO: THE NEW CAPTAIN AMERICA

- **Bucky refuses.** Tony: *"He asked for you. I'm just the mailman."*
- **Bucky's first mission as Captain America**, with **a pistol on his hip** (616): *"I'm not Steve. I never will be."*
- **The Skull's plan:** **Sin** and **Crossbones** create chaos in American cities; **Faustus** conditions agents; **the Kronas Corporation** (Lukin's) buys up America's debt.
- **Sharon**, free of Faustus, finds out **the gun wasn't a gun**. It was **Doom's technology**. *"He's not dead. He's stuck."*

### ACT THREE: REBORN

- **Steve, unstuck in time**, relives his life: **Project: Rebirth**, **Bucky in 1944**, **Peggy**, **the Howling Commandos**, and **the ice**, over and over. **He knows it's happening. He can't change anything.**
  - **The Skull's real plan** is to **pull Steve back into the present and take his body**.
  - **The Skull does it.** For one terrible scene **Steve's face smiles the Skull's smile** in front of the whole nation.
  - **Inside Steve's mind**, on a **1944 battlefield**, **Steve beats the Skull** (Hugo Weaving) with his bare hands.
  - **The Skull flees into a Zola robot body**, and **Sharon destroys it**.
  - **Steve is back.** Bucky holds out the shield. **Steve:** *"You keep it, Buck. Right now the country needs you."*
  - **The last scene:** Steve, in plain clothes, looks at **the two Earths in the sky** and calls **Maria Hill**. *"The Illuminati. I want every one of them found."*
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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, November 16, 2026</b> (the shooting, 9:42 a.m.) → <b>Saturday, February 6, 2027</b> .<br>Flashbacks through Steve's time-slip: <b>1940–1945</b> and <b>2011–2026</b> .             |
| Where it's set          | <b>New York City</b> (the federal courthouse, Brooklyn) · <b>Arlington National Cemetery</b> · <b>Washington, D.C.</b> · <b>the Kronas tower, Moscow</b> · <b>1944 Europe</b> (the time-slip) |
| Relative to other films | It follows <i>World War Hulk</i> (which ends September 19, 2026). It sets up <i>Avengers: Time Runs Out</i> , where Steve leads the hunt for the Illuminati.                                  |

## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Bucky Barnes is Captain America.** Steve is alive, **full power, no shield**, and **angrier than he's ever been**.
- **The Red Skull is destroyed** (for now).
- **Sin** escapes.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                            | How it appears                    | Payoff                                                                              |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bucky as Cap</b>             | He keeps the shield               | <i>Time Runs Out</i>                                                                |
| <b>Steve without the shield</b> | "Right now the country needs you" | On 616 Steve <b>takes back the shield</b> after <i>Fear Itself</i> (2011). Phase 6. |
| <b>Sin</b>                      | She gets away                     | Phase 6                                                                             |

### Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

| Seed                          | How it appears             | What it means                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Doom's time technology</b> | Inside the gun             | <b>Doom is studying how to survive outside time</b> , which is how he'll survive the end of everything |
| <b>The Illuminati hunt</b>    | Steve's call to Maria Hill | <i>Avengers: Time Runs Out</i>                                                                         |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | ✅ "THE SHIELD." Bucky, alone in Avengers Mansion, <b>tries to throw the shield the way Steve does</b> . It <b>misses</b> and <b>smashes a vase</b> . Sam, from the doorway: <i>"...We'll work on it."</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Post-credit scene      | ✅ "DATA." Castle Doom, Latveria. A Doombot hands <b>Doom</b> a smoking wreck: the gun's firing mechanism. Doom reads the data on a screen: <b>Steve's 12 weeks outside time</b> .<br><b>DOOM:</b> <i>"Twelve weeks outside time. And the man came back... himself."</i><br>He looks up <b>at the two Earths in the sky</b> .<br><b>DOOM:</b> <i>"Then it can be done."</i> CUT TO BLACK. <b>"CAPTAIN AMERICA WILL RETURN."</b> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: <b>"PRACTICE ROUND."</b> Post-credit: <b>"RECEIPTS."</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline